TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, MARCH 9, 2022
6:30 PM
AMENDED

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In attendance were Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Bethany Skipper-Greer, Dave Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan, James Lavin and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance were: Katina Spaulding, Utilities/Accts. Payable Manager; Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager; Sean Clayton, Police Chief; Andrew Bateman, Fire Chief; Bob Milie, Town Administrator; Charlie Barrow, Town Attorney; Deatre Denion, Clerk of Council.

   Mayor Williams stated facemasks are now optional in Town Hall. Mayor Williams asked Clerk of Council Denion to explain the sign in sheet. Clerk of Council Denion stated for record keeping, please print your name and address on the paper provided at the podium before speaking. Town Administrator Milie spoke of the current tornado watch the Town was under. In case there is a need, Chief Clayton and Chief Bateman will lead attendees down to the first floor in the center of the building.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the agenda with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of February 9, 2022

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to approve the meeting minutes from February 9, 2022. Council Member Ward made the motion to approve last month's meeting minutes with a second by Council Member Crenshaw.

5. **Presentations:**

   a) **Proclamation in honor of Fred B. Corey**

   Mayor Williams read a proclamation in honor of Fred B. Corey. Many family members were in attendance.

   b) **Recognition of Officer Charles Wilson**

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Mayor Williams recognized Officer Charles Wilson for his work in the capture of the Parker's robber.

c) **Presentations from Recorder Candidates:**

Each candidate below introduced themselves and provided a quick resume asking for citizens of Thunderbolt to vote for them as Recorder's Court Judge.

i) **Richard Sanders –**
ii) Joe Huffman –
iii) Anthony Burton –

d) **Finance Report:**

Ms. Brett was in attendance. Mayor and Council have received the executive summary and the financials. Everything is up to date. The March financials will have a QS1 report to compare with the traditional reports. Ms. Brett stated they were helping Chief Clayton with the asset forfeiture report. They are working with auditors for the audit. Monica Wood is taking the lead with gathering the information the auditors requested. Town Administrator Milie stated Mrs. Wood found some more revenue from last year. Currently the Town has spent 17% of the budget. It is a little over the 16.6% allotted amount but that is normal for the beginning of the year. Council Member Crenshaw asked about being delinquent with a balanced budget. Town Administrator stated we are not delinquent, there will be no penalty.

6. **Consent Agenda:**

a) **Approval of Alcohol License Renewal for Tipsy Turtle -188 Old Tybee Rd**

b) **Approval of Transfer of Alcohol License to Vrinda Investments Inc. – 2301 E. Victory Dr**

c) **Approval of WaterFirst MOU**

d) **Outdoor Event Permit and Waiver for Easter Egg Hunt in Ceseroni Park**

e) **Approve New Home Occupation Permit at 3228 Bannon Rd**

f) **Approve New Home Occupation Permit at 3128 Robertson Ave**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to approve the Consent Agenda. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion was unanimously.**

7. **Debate Agenda:**

a) **Approval of the Blessing of the Fleet Event Contract**

Marianne Ganem-Poppell was present. Town Administrator Milie explained the desire of Mayor and Council to bring back the Blessing of the Fleet. There is a loose plan and a budget of $70,000. The date of the event is around Memorial Day. Town Administrator Milie explained Mrs. Ganem-Poppell is working with State Farm to organize the Easter Egg Hunt. Mayor Williams stated starting this event again has to be done correctly so it will stay as an event from here on. This is a way to teach new comers the history of this Town. Ms. Ganem-Poppell stated this is a great opportunity for the Town and the citizens. Town Administrator Milie stated part of the contract is to create a social media presence and will be handled by them for six months. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the contract to not exceed $35,000. Council Member Crenshaw seconded the motion.** Council Member Skipper – Greer asked for more information on social media. Town Administrator Milie stated social media presence is a goal for Mayor and Council. Mrs. Ganem-Poppell will create profiles on Linkin, Facebook and Instagram. This will be for more than one event. Thunderbolt will own everything. Council Member Drohan asked is the Blessing of the Fleet one day. Town Administrator Milie stated it is. Council Member Drohan asked how many are expected. Mrs. Ganem-Poppell stated estimated 2500.

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Council Member Drohan asked about parking. Mrs. Ganem-Poppell stated she has spoken to some community partners, Johnson High School and TMI about utilizing their property for parking and shuttling them to the event. Council Member Barbaree asked for a comparison to other events in the area. Mrs. Ganem-Poppell stated the Seafood Festival or a 1st Saturday on River Street. Council Member Barbaree asked about vendor sign up. Mrs. Ganem-Poppell stated they will have a registration form to be submitted. Mayor Williams called for the vote. The motion passed unanimously.

b) **Approval of Atlantic Waste Contract**

Town Administrator Milie explained this is not truly a contract. In the current contract if Atlantic Waste's costs go up, they can increase. They have increased their cost to the Town from $19 to $21. Council Member Drohan asked what was in the budget. Town Administrator Milie stated about $20. Town Administrator Milie stated Thunderbolt will eat the cost difference. Council Member Drohan stated we need to look at how we bill for Utilities. If we can reduce cost of mailing out bills, it would assist with this increase. Council Member Crenshaw asked if there is still a kill clause. Town Administrator stated there is. Council Member Lavin asked about the difference in the contract vs what is billed. Town Administrator Milie stated there will be no increase to the citizen. Town Attorney Barrow stated no vote is needed for this item.

c) **Approval of City of Savannah Wastewater Agreement**

Town Administrator Milie explained this is a change required by EPD. There is no financial change. Currently, Public Works does the compliance aspect. EPD now requires the compliance to be completed by the permit holder. Town Attorney Barrow explained there will need to be a minor change in the ordinance to be in compliance with this agreement. Council Member Crenshaw stated for the benefit of the citizens in the audience the contract with Savannah does not end until 2029. Town Administrator Milie stated he met with City of Savannah to open the dialog on more capacity. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked if there is a financial change with this agreement. Town Administrator Milie stated there is not. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the agreement with a second by Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.**

d) **Approval of Website Vendor**

Town Administrator Milie explained the Town solicited six bids. A committee was created to provide input on what is needed. Out of the six bid requests, the current host did not provide a quote. Three quotes were submitted. Revised was the group choice. The new website would allow for sign up to pay for their bills or have them withdrawn from their bank account. Council Member Ward asked about monthly fee. Town Administrator Milie stated it is a $2500 annually fee. Council Member Barbaree asked about a contract. Town Administrator Milie stated there is a set up cost then the annual cost. Mayor Williams stated for his personal business this is the industry standard. Council Member Drohan asked if there is any estimate on the savings. Town Administrator Milie explained he did not have an idea. He is not sure how many will sign up for it. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked staff about their feelings. Clerk of Council Denion stated Revise was her choice for meeting everyone's needs. Council Member Barbaree asked about those for who do not have resources to do so on a computer or smartphone. Town Administrator Milie stated a kiosk has been discussed. Council Member Ward suggested a total cost for the website vendors to have a hard cost. Town Administrator Milie explained there were only two quotes and Town Web is still more. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to go with Revise provided the Council receives a breakdown of total cost. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.** Town Administrator Milie stated this is within the 2022 budget.

e) **Approval of Host Compliance Vendor**

This is for STR compliance. Host Compliance was less and heads above the other choice. Tybee uses them. Mayor Williams asked if Town Administrator Milie spoke with other communities who used them as a vendor. Town Administrator Milie stated he did call one in Florida and Tybee. **Council Member Ward made motion to approve the choice of Host Compliance as the compliance vendor for STR. Council Member Crenshaw seconded the motion.** Council Member Barbaree asked about rate on number of STR. Town Administrator Milie explained this is based on the 70 number.

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Citizen Bethany Skipper – Greer, 3210 Gilreath Street, notice the cost of permit/registration was listed in the cost of the STR permit. Clerk of Council Denion explained the Host Compliance is not doing the actual registration and permitting, that still is what she would have to do. It will provide the platform to submit the registration and permit request. Host Compliance will be doing the monitoring.

Mayor Williams called for the vote. **Council Members Drohan and Skipper-Greer recused themselves. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie explained the Town did receive the grant for the force main. The good news is the funding will be available next year. We are still waiting to hear on Fire Fighter Assistance Grant. A grant for Senior Citizen Center has been applied for.

Town Administrator Milie asked Chief Clayton to speak on the Blueline Contract. Chief Clayton explained all of the permit applications have been submitted. We are just waiting on GDOT approval. Council Member Crenshaw asked for Chief Clayton to explain the Blueline Contract to those who might not have been in attendance when approved. Chief Clayton explained the contract is for speed camaras for school zone. Maury Gallaher, 25 Bonaventure, asked about placing a camara where there is a school zone sign near his house. It was explained that is not a school zone and should be removed. These cameras are only for school zones and it will be on Whatley.

9. **Department Report –** Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police - Wiliams stated
Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager
Crosby spoke on Chlorides 70 parts per mil. 10 parts per mil. – Water cannot be used for well.

Town Administrator Milie stated there needs to be changes to pump station security. The Town is collecting quotes for this change. With gas prices increasing, Town Administrator Milie explained a need for increased security to prevent gas theft.

Town Administrator Milie updated Mayor and Council on the new library tenants. They new tenants have paid for the year in advance. They are painting the building and have chosen a Victory Drive District approved color. Town staff made improvements to plumbing and bathroom for proper functioning.

Town Administrator Milie stated the Customer Service Training has been scheduled for all Town staff to attend. GMA is doing the training on April 11th. He is still working with GMA on an doing an alcohol audit.

Town Administrator Milie met with the new City of Savannah's City Manager. They have opened a dialog about the sewer force main.

Town Administrator Milie gave a Bannon Drive update. Temporary speed bumps have been placed on Bannon Drive. A three way stop sign has been placed on Bannon and George St. Tuberson has been blocked at River Supply preventing thru traffic. There have been complaints about the blocking of Tuberson but none of the complaints have come from those living on Tuberson. Town Administrator Milie explained this is not the final decision on addressing the trucks using Bannon St. The blocking of Tuberson has caused an issue of cars going onto private property to go around the barricade. Police have been stationed there to ticket those who do go around the blockade. Council Member Drohan stated he understands the concern about safety and damage from trucks coming onto Bannon. Steps we have gone to by blocking off Tuberson has stopped trucks but traffic is like water, it goes to least resistance. Council Member Drohan had a traffic expert come and look at the issue. One option is to use Whatley to Falligant, unfortunately there is an ordinance making it unlawful for large truck to use Whatley Ave, south of Gilreath. We have a weight limit in Town for 2 and 3 axle trucks but not 5 axles. This needs to be

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address. Council Member Drohan asked Sue DeLarosa, 3215 Bannon, to come forward and speak of the traffic before the barricade and after. Ms. DeLarosa stated when Tuberson was blocked off it went silent. When the truck ordinance was passed, they did not follow going one way.

Ms. Yvonne Feltovic, 3220 Gilreath stated she has seen 18 wheelers backing up to River Drive. She expressed her dislike for Tubberson being blocked off and there being too many stop signs on Bannon St. She stated it seems excessive. Ms. Feltovic stated if you are going to place more stop signs, Gilreath needs some to stop drivers from flying down the street.

Council Member Crenshaw came before Council and citizens and referenced the last meeting. He stated his integrity has been questioned. He asked each of his neighbors to come forth and speak on his behalf. John Cheeks,2711 River Dr, stated Council Member Crenshaw's backyard adjoins my backyard. Mr. Cheecks stated he did not have a problem with the business. The business has been in operation for a good 15 years. Mr. Cheecks stated this was never a problem until this election.

Krista Kilburn, 3215 Center Street, stated she is a new resident and lives right across the street from Council Member Crenshaw. There is no activity or noise coming from the business. She has no issue with Council Member Crenshaw having his business there.

Evan Parker, 3217 Center Street, stated he purchased his home two years ago. He stated he did not buy a house to have an AirB&B to have strangers coming and going. He likes the safety aspect of having the Council Member Crenshaws business knowing they are there certain times and knowing who is across the street. Mr. Parkere stated he appreciateed the neighbors he has.

Council Member Crenshaw stated Emile Bootsma, another neighbor is in the audience but for time he would stop there.

Stella Lavin, 3125 Robertson Avenue, stated why she brought this up was whether Council Member Crenshaw had a license. She stated she did not have issue with the business.

10. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

11. **Mayor and Council –**
    a) Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan
    See notes

Council Member Drohan discussed the cost and savings of utilizing graywater.

Current vs Graywater Systems Using W&S Fees Effective 3/1/2022

	Current System	Graywater System	Net Gain/Savings
Average Usage	6500 gal	6500 gal	
Customer Fee BR $22.55+ Usage $45.08=	80.08	80.08	
Sewage Processed	6500 gal	2600 gal (@40%)	
Savannah Charge	38.06 (6500 gal)	15.22 (2600 gal)	
Net to T'Bolt	42.02	64.86	$22.84/unit/month
100x12	50,424	77,832	

Net Income Gain

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Net to T'Bolt			
Pre Rebate	42.02	49.64	$7.62/unit/month

Net Cash Flow Gain

Current System	Graywater System
$0.00	$22.84 + $7.62 = $30.44/unit/month

Annual Gross Cash Flow Gain	=	$30.44 x 12 = $365.28/year/unit
Gain with 100 units	=	$36,528.00
Gain Over 10 years	=	$365,280.00

Rebate Considerations

Gross Cash Flow Gain $30.44 x 12 x 100 x 10 years = $365,280.00

10 Year Cost of Rebate @ 100% Savannah Fee	$15.22 x 12 x 100x 10 =	$182,640.00	($1826.40/unit)

10 Year Net Gain in T'Bolt Cash Flow	=	$182.640.00

At this point while the benefits of a graywater system are clear, the cost of establishing a passive graywater system in a residence is unclear. I am requesting that I be allowed to create a passive graywater system at my home. I will pay for the entire system out of my own pocket and I will return the plumbing to any state required by code should this system prove unworkable.

My hope is to create a baseline cost for a residential graywater system that will fall within the 10-year rebate horizon of $1826.40.

Shallow Well Options

Utilizing shallow wells to water residential landscape areas has been long discussed as a central part of water management in the Town of Thunderbolt. The recent challenge regarding this strategy has been the significant increases in costs to have these wells drilled commercially.

In my own situation, I ultimately failed to complete my well by hand due to the density and depth of the dense gray clay substrata directly above the subsurface water that often runs 6 to 10 feet deep, depending upon your location. At that time, I did turn to a commercial well digging company to complete the project. The price of that time was reasonable and given my strong emphasis on conservation practices, I saw this as a reasonable and conservation friendly decision on my part.

Current Cost Challenges

Recent reports regarding citizens desiring shallow wells have been in the $4000 range. By all estimates, these current costs will easily surpass whatever savings one might gain from reduced possible water usage for landscape purposes, even if one were to project the savings over a 10-year horizon. As a result, a commercial model for the creation of shallow wells locally becomes problematic.

Past Practices

In the past, to minimize the costs associated with these projects, there have been groups of three or four neighbors who have cooperatively drilled wells by hand and as a result, came up with a very cost-efficient and conservation friendly solution to providing water for our yards and gardens.

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Citizens' Conservation Committee

One of my thoughts has been the creation of a Citizens' Conservation Committee that would be made up of interested residents of the Town of Thunderbolt who, in conjunction with the ad hoc Committee on Water and Sewer, provide feedback to the Council regarding the attitudes of the citizens of Thunderbolt relative to water conservation practices.

This committee could also be a mechanism whereby citizens could work as a team to create shallow wells for one another.

This could as well be a mechanism for citizens interested in a shallow well for their property, who because of financial concerns or physical capacity cannot create a shallow well on their properties by themselves to benefit from the community spirit inherent in this type of organization.

"To Be or Not To Be"

During the last election cycle, there was a great deal of discussion with regards to creating a greater sense of community and what has become a rapidly changing social and physical landscape in the Town of Thunderbolt.

I consider this an opportunity for the citizens of Thunderbolt, with the support of the Town Council and the town administration to advance the concepts of "neighborliness" and "helping out the other guy" as a part of the experience of being a resident and citizen and the Town of Thunderbolt.



Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to move into Executive Session. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

12. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

    Mayor Williams asked for a motion to reconvene in open session **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

13. **Approval of Museum Lease Agreement**

    Town Administrator explain this is a lease that has been reviewed by Town Attorney Barrow and Council. Staff recommends to approve for the rest of the year. It does have a sunset clause for Dec. 31. **Council Member**

Drohan made the motion to accept as written. Council Member Skipper-Greer seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.

Anna Maria Thomas thanked Mayor and Council and stated the museum would be open starting April 6th.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion and a second to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Adjournment:**

Meeting adjourned at 9:17 pm.

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